

HS 526: Human Geography: A Western Himalayan Perspective

Course Code	HS 526
Course Name	Human Geography: A Western Himalayan Perspective
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	Post graduate students, 3rd and 4th Year B.Tech. students
Distribution	Core course for M.A. in Development Studies, Elective for others
Approval	23rd BoA (Apr 2018); 16th Senate (Apr 2018)

Course Contents

- **Why does Human Geography Matter?** [4 Lectures]
 - Defining Human Geography: Themes and relevance
 - Introduction to a spatial perspective: regional and global
 - What are the basic geographic questions?
 - Environmental Determinism: debates
- **Economic Geography** [8 Lectures]
 - Geography of the world economy: Measurement and problems
 - Trends in agriculture (India/Himachal Pradesh/Western Himalaya)
 - Food production and food security (Himachal Pradesh/ Western Himalaya)
 - Worlds of consumption: Global and local geographies of consumption
- **Population Geography** [8 Lectures]
 - Geography of health
 - Population dynamics
 - Migration: push and pull factors
 - Indias demographic profile and National Population Policy
- **Geography across Global and Regional History: Urbanization** [5 Lectures]
 - Urbanization: A global survey of trends and patterns
 - Case Study: Imperial and Post-Colonial Shimla
- **Humans and Nature** [6 Lectures]
 - Natural Disasters and Human Intervention (19th-20th century India)
 - Human-Animal Conflict and Cooperation in India (Ancient to Contemporary India)
- **Cultural Geography: Space and Society** [5 Lectures]
 - Language: Linguistic Nationalism in India
 - Religion and the cultural landscape in Himachal Pradesh/ Western Himalaya
- **Case Study** [6 Lectures]
 - Change and Continuity in Himachal Pradesh/ Western Himalaya (19th-20th centuries) from the perspective of Human Geography

Text Books

1. Fouberg, Erin H. et al. **Human Geography: People, Place, and Culture**, 11th Edition, Wiley, 2015.
2. Cloke, Paul et al. **Introducing Human Geographies**, 3rd Edition, Routledge, 2014.

References

1. Alam, Aniket., **Becoming India: Western Himalaya under British Rule**, Cambridge University Press. 2008.
2. Coe, Neil et al., **Economic Geography: A Contemporary Introduction**, Wiley, 2013.
3. Diamond, Jared., **Guns, Germs and Steel: The Fate of Human Societies**, WW Norton, 2017.
4. Elmore, Mark., **Becoming Religious in a Secular Age**, University of California Press, 2016.
5. Guha, Ramachandra, **Environmentalism: A Global History**, Penguin Random House India, 2016.
6. Roy, Tirthankar., **Natural Disasters and Indian History**, Oxford University Press, 2012.
7. Singh, Chetan., **Natural Premises: Ecology and Peasant Life in the Western Himalaya, 1800-1950**, Oxford University Press, 1998.